3. Decisions on other questions, including the determination of additional categories of questions to be decided by a two-thirds majority, shall be made by a majority of the members present and voting.

Article 19 contains provisions; which debar a member from exercising the voting rights in the Assembly. It states that “A Member of the United Nations which is in arrears in the payment of its financial contributions to the Organization shall have no vote in the General Assembly if the amount of its arrears equals or exceeds the amount of the contributions due from it for the preceding two full years. The General Assembly may, nevertheless, permit such a Member to vote if it is satisfied that the failure to pay is due to conditions beyond the control of the Member”.

In recent years, efforts have been made to achieve consensus on issues, rather than deciding by a formal vote. The President, after having consulted and reached an agreement with the delegations, can propose that a resolution be adopted without a vote.

Evaluation

The General Assembly is by far the most important organ of the United Nations. It is the largest organ comprising all the member states and is known as the **town-meeting of the world**. Given the nature of limited membership of the Security Council, the General Assembly becomes the platform of the developing nations and provides a forum for collective bargaining. The Assembly’s power reached its zenith with the passing of the Uniting for Peace Resolution and it met several challenges to peacekeeping using this resolution. But from the sixties onwards, with the resumption of functions relating to matters of peacekeeping and international security, by the Security Council, the role of General Assembly has declined. But this has not made the Assembly an ineffective organ, and it still continues to be the world’s Parliament and a forum for deliberation and discussion. The supervisory functions of the Assembly still continue and its effort to work towards a peaceful secure world by promoting peaceful cooperation among nations still remains its main objective. Further, to make the United Nations more